

Senior Design Essay
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This senior design project is a culmination of the different skills I've learned throughout my time at UC. It is also an opportunity for me to apply my skills in different areas than I would normally need to in a class or project. I can focus less on the technical aspects of what a project needs to be and what it must accomplish, and focus more on the design aspects and what makes it *feel* good as a developer or as a user. I can help design a smooth, consistent, pleasing piece of software instead of trying to meet assignment requirements. I get a more broad and expansive experience this way which steps into territory I have not yet explored on my own as a developer or student.

First and foremost, the work ethic and time management demanded by any semester full of classwork translates easily to such a project. I must be willing to put in effort to complete my classes, and the same is true for this project. The same is also true for timeliness, especially when teammates are involved. I think the knowledge I've gained from all the programming and studying for all my classes is vital for me to be able to contribute to the project. For example, the Software Engineering course (EECE3093C) was all about this exact kind of group work and collaboration with peers. I know how to solve problems and find necessary information when I don't. I also know how to share that information and collaborate with my peers to make sure we're all on the same page.

As for co-op experiences, I think these will be the most helpful to me for contributing to this project. Namely, my time at Cincinnati Inc. as a Software Engineer and experience with learning Unity and programming in C# will be incredibly valuable for this project. I spent a lot of energy reading through documentation and explanations while experimenting in the engine myself. The similarities between my work here and there are clear, and the skills gained will translate well especially if the project uses C# at all. My other co-op experiences will help too, as any job would with me needing to communicate clearly and quickly to people. I'm well versed in discussing project work with others and reaching out for assistance if necessary.

I am very excited to be working on a game development project, especially with other people. I have not yet had the chance to work with a group on designing a game, so this will hopefully be a very valuable experience to me. Additionally, with a few more hands on deck, hopefully we can create a higher quality product than one of us might alone. I get to assume the role of a lead designer and help guide the vision of this project towards its completion. This is a role I haven't been able to sit in before, and I think I can do a great job with it thanks to my past experience with designing at my jobs and with games. At the same time I can provide further utility to the team as someone who can program and help architect the game from a technical perspective as well.

At the end of this project we expect to have a game that we are happy to play and proud to market. This is the main objective; the product doesn't need to be perfect from a technical standpoint, but it will be something we can be proud to have made. I will evaluate my own contributions based on a very subjective set of criteria. The biggest criterion is that I should think whatever work I know I've contributed to the project should be exciting to me. If I can look at the work I've put in for the game and know it's tangibly satisfying, then I know I've done a good job. There shouldn't be any holes left either, no missing features or lacking implementations. There will be a point at which I no longer want to return to working on the project, otherwise it's incomplete! There will be nothing left for me to notice that needs more time and effort put in to not notice it anymore; the canvas must be fully painted.